- How well is/are your development team(s) working together?

We dive deep into source control in chapter 4.

1.3.3. The build system

After someone checks something into source control, it typically goes into your build system, which is where the code from multiple check-ins is integrated, unit tests are run, your code is packaged into something that can be deployed somewhere, and reports are generated. All of this is called continuous integration (CI). From here you can get lots of great information on your code: you can see how well your team's changes are coordinated, run your codebase against rule sets to ensure you're not making silly mistakes, check your test coverage, and see automated test results.

CI is an essential part of team software development, and there are several systems that help you get going quickly, including TeamCity, Jenkins, Hudson, and Bamboo. Some teams have taken CI past the integration phase and have their system deploy their code while they're at it. This is called continuous delivery (CD). Many of the same systems can be employed to do CD, but there are products that specialize in it, like ThoughtWorks, Go CD, Electric Cloud, and Nolio.

Whether you're doing CI or CD, the main thing you need to care about is the information that is generated when your code is getting built, inspected, and tested. The more mature a CI/CD process your team has, the more data you can get out of it.

Here are questions you can answer from CI alone:

- How fast are you delivering changes to your consumer?
- How fast can you deliver changes to your consumer?
- How consistently does your team do STET work?

More details on the data you can get from this step are found in chapter 5.